Responsible Administrator: CEMO
Responsible Office: Enrollment Management
Effective Date: January 2026
Approved by: President
Date of Revision: 12/02/2025

Southeastern Emergency Assistance Fund Policy

Policy Statement

This policy applies to administration and eligibility of emergency assistance funds for students, faculty, and staff. The policy will be reviewed annually by the Southeastern Emergency Assistance Fund Committee. Policy recommendations may require President's Staff approval.

Purpose of Policy

The Southeastern Emergency Assistance Fund provides limited, short-term financial assistance to students, faculty, and staff of the University who are experiencing unforeseen and urgent financial hardships. The fund is designed to help maintain stability during unexpected crises, enabling recipients to continue their academic, professional, and personal responsibilities.

Applicability

The guidelines set forth in this policy apply to the administration of Emergency assistance funds by the committee and eligibility of students, faculty, and staff.

Policy Procedure

Students must:

1. be currently enrolled at least half-time in a degree or certificate program at Southeastern. Guest and cross-enrolled students are ineligible for emergency funding.
2. be in good disciplinary standing with the university (not on probation, suspension, or under investigation for misconduct at the time of application)
3. have a valid/active FAFSA on file. All financial aid resources must be accepted before receiving any funding from the Southeastern Assistance Fund, including Direct Student Loans and PLUS Loans.

Faculty/Staff must:

1. be a current full-time or part-time faculty or staff member employed by the University. Temporary or contract positions are excluded.
2. must have completed a minimum period of employment at Southeastern of 1 year prior to applying, unless the emergency is deemed exceptional.

All applicants must:

- have a documented emergency or unexpected expense and demonstrate genuine financial hardship (e.g., inability to meet basic living expenses such as housing, food, utilities, or transportation due to the emergency).

ELIGIBLE EXPENSES

- Housing insecurity or eviction notice
- Utility shut-off or past-due bills
- Medical or dental emergencies
- Prescription medication
- Transportation (e.g., car repair, bus pass)
- Replacement of essential personal belongings due to fire, theft, or natural disaster
- Emergency childcare expenses
- Other expenses as determined by the Southeastern Assistance Fund Committee

INELIGIBLE EXPENSES

- Tuition, fees, and other anticipated school-related expenses covered by financial aid (unless related to emergency continuation of enrollment)
- Elective medical or dental procedures
- Legal fees not related to the crisis
- Routine financial shortfalls, debt payments, or non-essential expenses

FUNDING

- Awards are subject to availability of funds.
- Individuals may only apply once within a 12-month period.
- Assistance is not a loan and does not require repayment.

APPLICATION PROCESS

- Applicants must complete the Southeastern Emergency Assistance Fund Request Form and submit supporting documentation (e.g., hospital bills, repair estimates, obituary, eviction notice).
- Applications are reviewed on a bi-weekly basis by the Southeastern Emergency Assistance Fund Committee.
- Decisions are communicated within a reasonable timeframe (5-10 business days).
- The Southeastern Assistance Fund Committee will determine eligibility and recommend an appropriate award amount, not to exceed $1,000.00. Under extenuating circumstances, the committee may recommend a higher amount. This amount must be approved by the Vice President of University Advancement.
- Funds may be disbursed via direct deposit, check, or as a credit to the student account, depending on the situation and/or nature of the expense.

COMMITTEE OVERSIGHT

The Southeastern Emergency Assistance Fund Committee is responsible for reviewing applications and determining award allocations. The committee is chaired by the Dean of Students, who also oversees all communication with student applicants. Decisions are made by majority vote. All decisions are final.

Composition

- Dean of Students
- Director of Financial Aid
- One representative from Auxiliary Services
- One representative from the Office of University Advancement
- One representative from the Controller's or Budget Office

Responsibilities

- Review applications in a fair and confidential manner

- Ensure consistency in decision-making and adherence to policy
- Maintain records of applications and disbursements for accountability

Confidentiality

A. Committee members must uphold the privacy of applicants, including all supporting documents, and may not disclose personal information outside the review process.

[End of Policy]